

minating somewhere in the history of the first-century Christian Church. On the history of this interpretation s. the Note at end of c. 9 and also that after c. 2. It is a vast mistake that has been perpetrated, especially by Protestant theologians in their disregard of the history of exegesis, to hold that the identification of the lower term of the 490 years with the epoch of Jesus Christ has always been the 'Christian' exegesis. This is false to the fact of the great variety of Christian interpretation.

d. Darius the Mede.

How then can we identify Darius the Mede? Such is his designation, and he was 62 years old, according to 6¹⁽²⁾. 9¹ makes him 'son of Xerxes, of the seed of the Medes,' who succeeded as king over the kingdom of the Chaldæans.⁷ In the Bible we learn of four Persian kings: Cyrus, *e.g.*, Ezr. 1; Artaxerxes, 4⁷; Darius 4⁵, 5^{6ff.}, probably Darius the Persian, Neh. 12²²—so the actual order in Ezr.-Neh.; and Xerxes, Est. 1, etc. Likewise according to Dan 11² there were four Pers. kings, *cf.* the 'four heads' of the symbolic beast 7⁶. This abbreviation of the length of the Persian empire has its counterpart in the later Jewish reckoning of but 34 years to the Pers. *régime*; s. Note on the Interpretation of the 70 Weeks, end of c. 9, *sub* (3). Our Darius the Mede is evidently distinguished from Darius the Persian. Boutflower, p. 143, notes six identifications that have been proposed for the Mede, two of them of recent origin. One of the elder identifications (s. Dr., p. liii) is Astyages, the Median king conquered by Cyrus, whom the latter is gratuitously supposed to have installed as viceroy in Babylon; another Cyaxares (II), who, according to Xenophon's *Cyropaedia*, viii, 5, 8, married his daughter to Cyrus; but according to i, 2, 1, Cyrus married a daughter of Astyages. We see how little confidence we can place upon Xenophon's romance. This lightness of later tradition is carried on by Josephus, who states, *AJ* x, 11, 4, that this Darius "with his kinsman Cyrus put an end to the dominion of Babylon; he was the son of Astyages (acc. to Dan., of Xerxes!), and had another name among the Greeks."

⁷ There is nothing cryptic in the expressions translated 'received the kingdom,' 6¹, and 'was made king,' 9¹, *v. ad locc.*; this against those who hold to indications that Darius was only a viceroy.